



Can we intercept nukes from space

The US military is looking at ways to intercept and stop nukes from orbit but experts say the dreams a bit farfetched. <https://dgit.in/feb19-71>



Online safety lesson to Girl Scouts

Cyber Squad is a new video game to help Junior Girl Scouts learn about cybersecurity, privacy and dealing with online bullies. <https://dgit.in/feb19-72>



It's the tech singularity!

Agent001 didn't find CES all that impressive. Here's his take on the biggest consumer tech show of the year.

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f you guys haven't been reading up on the latest happenings at CES, then you're not missing much.

Gone are the days when CES used to be the only consumer technology show of note. Now a days we have tech events for practically every month on the calendar. CES got over, then comes MWC, then there's IFA, COMPUTEX, Gamescom, GDC, etc. spread throughout the year. Moreover, niche specific conferences and shows have always been around and for brands that don't wish to fight for media attention, they have their own set of events. The end result is that all these technology shows have lost their lustre and have become a watered down version of their former selves. So what did we find interesting this year?

Quite a bit, to be honest.

Virtual assistants were battling it out for supremacy on the show floor. They're starting to get a bit ridiculous as well. The usual marriages (virtual assistants in speakers) were in plenty. Major manufacturers had already integrated Alexa and Google assistant into their mid-range speakers to test waters in early 2018. This year, they were integrated in all the luxury products and

high-end speakers. Amazon even went ahead and put Alexa into the latest BMW 530E. If you can't afford a BMW then you can always buy one of those car accessories that plug into your car and give you a slightly watered down experience. Like I said, they're everywhere. Your privacy went out of the window a decade ago and tech companies went laughing to the advertisers with your data. Now they're just doing it in your face. And the madness doesn't stop there. We even saw Alexa

see more of Alexa integrated devices in the years to come.

The other thing we noticed was that more of the component and peripheral manufacturers were bundling their products together to make complete PCs. There was an age when these very manufacturers would have shrugged at the suggestion of offering complete PCs but now that PC sales have dropped, they've resorted to any trick that'll get them those sales numbers back. The most they did was

offer small form factor PCs but now they've come out guns blazing with top of the line configurations. Brands which were hitherto known just for making components have gone into the building complete PC solutions. Ever thought of MSI and GIGABYTE would have their own monitors? Well, they do now. GIGABYTE even had SSDs and RAM



being integrated into a toilet. Yes, we're talking about the Kohler Numi 2.0 that can now warm up your seat and activate the bidet for some automated hygiene action. Where does the it stop? Speaking to a couple of folks on the ground, I learnt that Amazon is a bit more proactive when it comes to working with brands to help them integrate Alexa into products. So be prepared to

modules at COMPTUEX 2018. It won't be long before they you'll buy a complete PC from one of these manufacturers instead of building your own from scratch. The whole thing about sticking to a niche and owning it is fading away, with their traditional channels of money slowly drying up, all these manufacturers are being forced to come up with such solutions.